

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 30, 2026

Loaded Week

A full five-session trading week opens Monday into the August payrolls print Friday and the Broadcom AI-semiconductor release, sequencing the September 15-16 FOMC rate decision after the Warsh Jackson Hole hawkish repricing.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	NASDAQ (QQQ, FRI CLOSE)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	SEPT HIKE ODDS (CME)	FEAR & GREED
\$769.35 · ↑~0.5% on the week	\$716.43 · ↑~0.9% on the week	~\$78,100 · ↓~2% vs Fri afternoon	~56-60% · up from ~35% pre-Warsh	~55 · Greed (CNN; drop crypto fallback)

SECTION 01

Markets — Week Ahead: A Full Five-Session Trading Week Opens Monday Into the August Employment Report Friday and Broadcom's AI-Semiconductor Release, Sequencing the September 15–16 FOMC Rate Decision After Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole Hawkish Repricing

SUNDAY SETUP: A FULL FIVE-SESSION TRADING WEEK SEQUENCES THE SEPTEMBER RATE-DECISION DISTRIBUTION AGAINST THE POST-WARSH HAWKISH RESET

Per NYSE calendar, US equity markets are open the full five sessions this week — Labor Day 2026 falls Monday, September 7 rather than the week ahead — and the sequence lands with the August Employment Report at 8:30 AM ET Friday, September 4 per BLS release schedule and Broadcom's (AVGO, not held by FCI) fiscal Q3 release after the close Wednesday, September 2 per company investor-relations calendar coverage cited in Blockonomi and Tickeron previews. Per CNBC and Reuters coverage of the CME FedWatch response to Chair Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole keynote, September-meeting probabilities for a quarter-point rate increase moved to approximately 55–60% Friday from roughly 35% Thursday, and per PBS NewsHour coverage of the two-year Treasury response, short-end yields moved higher by roughly 11–12 basis points to approximately 4.34–4.36%. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hawkish first-Fed-Chair Jackson Hole keynote sitting sixteen calendar days from the September FOMC and one full trading week from the incremental payrolls-and-services cadence — sets the sleeve reading through the sequential data print rather than the prior release captured in Saturday's brief.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$769.35 · ↑~0.5% on the week
FCI BOTTOM-3 FRIDAY	MRVL ↓10.28% · MARA ↓10.11% · HUT ↓8.85%
FCI TOP-4 FRIDAY	NOW ↑4.54% · SYK ↑2.66% · ATAT ↑2.33% · SPGI ↑1.72%
BITCOIN (LIVE)	~\$78,100 · Below Fri afternoon level
AUG PAYROLLS (BLS)	Fri Sept 4 · 8:30 AM ET
AVGO FISCAL Q3	Est ~\$3.22 EPS · ~\$16B AI semi rev

THE WEEK'S CATALYST STACK LINES UP CLEANLY — ISM MANUFACTURING, JOLTS, ADP, BEIGE BOOK, ISM SERVICES, AVGO, AND THE EMPLOYMENT REPORT CADENCE INTO THE SEPTEMBER 15–16 FOMC

Per Schaeffer's Investment Research and FXStreet week-ahead previews, the sequence carries the ISM Manufacturing PMI and July construction spending Tuesday, the JOLTS Job Openings & Labor Turnover Survey also Tuesday, the ADP National Employment Report and the Fed's Beige Book Wednesday, the July trade balance and ISM Services PMI Thursday, and the August Employment Report (nonfarm

payrolls, unemployment rate, average hourly earnings) at 8:30 AM ET Friday per BLS calendar; per company investor-relations coverage cited in Blockonomi and Tickeron, Broadcom (AVGO, not held by FCI) is expected to release fiscal Q3 results midweek with sell-side consensus near \$3.22 EPS on approximately \$16 billion of AI-semiconductor revenue — the incremental read into the custom-silicon-hyperscaler complex following the NVDA beat-and-raise on August 27 and the MRVL sequential-timing compression on August 28. Per Federal Reserve calendar, the September 15–16 FOMC meeting sits sixteen calendar days out from today. For FCI positioning, the composition — a full trading week that opens post-holiday-adjacent, carries the labor-market cadence Tue-through-Friday, layers the AVGO custom-silicon read midweek, and hands the sleeve two clean catalysts (payrolls and AI-semi guidance) heading into the September FOMC — sets the incremental September rate-decision distribution against a jobs-and-services read that historically tends to move the front-end curve materially in either direction.

A trading week that layers a marquee AI-semiconductor release against the incremental labor-market cadence and closes with the payrolls print sitting eleven calendar days from the FOMC tends to sequence the front-end curve rather than the multiple. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics — Iran Marked the Six-Month Anniversary of the US War With a Diplomatic-Off-Ramp Signal Conditioned on Sanctions Relief, the Iran-Oman Hormuz Corridor Framework Continues to Advance Through the Qatari-Tehran Mediation Track, and Ukraine's Deep-Range Refinery Campaign Has Pushed Russian Oil Refining Toward Multi-Decade Lows Into the Sunday Setup

IRAN SIGNALLED A DIPLOMATIC OFF-RAMP AT THE SIX-MONTH WAR ANNIVERSARY CONDITIONED ON THE US ENDING ITS PRESSURE CAMPAIGN — THE IRAN-OMAN CORRIDOR FRAMEWORK CONTINUES TO ADVANCE THROUGH THE QATARI-MEDIATED TEHRAN TRACK

Per The Manila Times and CBS News coverage of the six-month war anniversary on Friday, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi indicated Tehran remains open to diplomacy but conditioned any return to the negotiating table on Washington abandoning its pressure campaign, characterizing sanctions and economic coercion as ineffective at moving Tehran to the table; per Wikipedia coverage of the ceasefire sequence, the April 8 two-week ceasefire was mediated by Pakistan and indefinitely extended by President Trump on April 21, and a June memorandum of understanding toward a final peace deal was signed but no comprehensive agreement has since materialized. Per Al Jazeera and The Hill coverage cited in the data drop and prior briefs, Iran and Oman have outlined a phased framework for a temporary Strait of Hormuz corridor with two-way shipping lanes separated by approximately two nautical miles across a total width of approximately seven nautical miles, and the Qatari Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani met with Foreign Minister Araghchi in Tehran on August 27 to advance the mediation track; per CBS News, Tehran maintains the position that the strait will remain closed as long as Washington has not fulfilled the June memorandum commitments on lifting the counterblockade and removing sanctions. Per data drop, USO closed Friday ↓0.24% at \$129.70 and BNO ↓0.44% at \$51.48 — the crude complex held roughly flat as the Warsh dollar-strength signal partially offset the physical-supply variable. For FCI positioning, the composition — a two-sided diplomatic signal at the six-month war anniversary, a Qatari-mediated Hormuz corridor framework advancing through Tehran, and a crude tape compressed by the post-Warsh dollar bid — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) reading through the intersection of the physical-friction floor and the diplomatic negotiating window into the September 24 Trump-Xi summit and the November 10 Kuala Lumpur truce expiry captured in prior briefs.

UKRAINIAN DRONES CONTINUED THE DEEP-RANGE RUSSIAN REFINERY CAMPAIGN THROUGH THE LATE-WEEK SEQUENCE — THE KUIBYSHEV SAMARA-OBLAST AND AFIPSKY KRASNODAR-KRAI STRIKES EXTENDED A CAMPAIGN THAT HAS DRIVEN RUSSIAN REFINING TOWARD THE LOWEST LEVEL IN MORE THAN TWO DECADES

Per Ukrainska Pravda, Yahoo News, and Kyiv Independent coverage of the overnight-into-August 28 strikes, Ukrainian forces hit the Kuibyshev refinery in Samara Oblast (approximately 800 kilometers from the border with a stated production capacity of approximately 7 million metric tons per year) and the Afipsky refinery in Krasnodar Krai, with Russia's Defense Ministry claiming forces downed approximately 102 Ukrainian drones overnight including 21 over Samara Oblast and 18 over Krasnodar Krai; per Moscow Times coverage of the cumulative campaign, Russian oil refining has fallen to approximately 3.8 million barrels per day in August — approaching the lowest level in more than two decades —

with Russian oil refineries attacked at least 21 times in the month per prior Mezha and Wikipedia coverage cited in the Saturday brief, the highest single-month count recorded in the current campaign. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines, the Trump administration signaled plans to meet with domestic refiners and fuel retailers as the Iran war continues to lift US gasoline prices ahead of the midterms, a domestic-policy read that continues to sit alongside the sanctions-and-diplomacy sequence. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Ukraine-Russia refinery campaign at deep-strike range compounding on the still-open Middle East supply variable while a stronger dollar suppresses the near-term crude reflection — keeps the FCI energy sleeve reading through the two-sided physical-friction expression that has sat structurally intact for six months.

THE US-EGYPT SANCTIONS PERIMETER WIDENS AS UAE CENTRAL BANK LAUNCHES AN URGENT EXAMINATION AND THE TRUMP-XI OVERCAPACITY TARIFF ADVANCES TOWARD THE SEPTEMBER 24 SUMMIT

Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines on the Egyptian-bank-branch review and UAE central-bank examination of Iran-linked exposure, Egypt's Banque Misr is reviewing the US Treasury secondary-sanctions notice served on multiple Egyptian bank branches at the six-month war mark and the UAE central bank launched an urgent examination of exposure — a widening of the enforcement perimeter that follows the Egyptian-bank-branch designations captured in Saturday's brief. Per Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, and WION coverage of the ongoing tariff track, the administration continues to prepare an incremental 7.5% overcapacity tariff on Chinese goods designed to bring the aggregate US-China tariff burden to approximately the 20% ceiling Beijing has signaled as consistent with the current truce, with the announcement engineered around the September 24 Wash-

ington state visit by President Xi — the first Chinese state visit in more than a decade; per Techtimes coverage, semiconductor-specific tariffs on Chinese product are approaching approximately 70% as the overcapacity layer stacks. Per CNBC coverage cited in the data drop headlines characterizing Secretary Bessent's remarks on disorderly yen moves as potentially destabilizing to global markets, Treasury engagement on Japanese yen intervention posture continues — a communication signal that sits alongside the Warsh Jackson Hole task-force reference on the Fed-Treasury balance-sheet framework debate captured in Saturday's brief. For FCI positioning, the composition — widening Iran-sanctions perimeter through Cairo and Abu Dhabi, an advancing US-China tariff track, and continued Treasury-Fed governance signal — extends the trade-and-geopolitical compound the sleeve has been reading through the third quarter and into the fourth.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — A Full Five-Session Trading Week Opens Monday Ahead of the August Employment Report Friday and Broadcom's AI-Semiconductor Fiscal Q3 Release Midweek; Labor Day 2026 Falls the Following Monday, September 7. Per NYSE calendar, this coming week carries the full Monday-through-Friday cash-market schedule, with Labor Day sitting one week out on Monday, September 7 — correcting the calendar framing in Saturday's brief. Per Schaeffer's Investment Research and FXStreet week-ahead previews, the sequence carries the ISM Manufacturing PMI, July construction spending, and JOLTS Job Openings & Labor Turnover Survey Tuesday, the ADP National Employment Report and the Fed Beige Book Wednesday, the July trade balance and ISM Services PMI Thursday, and the August Employment Report (nonfarm payrolls, unemployment rate, average hourly earnings) at 8:30 AM ET Friday per BLS release schedule; per Blockonomi and Tickeron previews, Broadcom (AVGO, not held by FCI) is expected to release fiscal Q3 midweek with consensus near \$3.22 EPS on roughly \$29 billion of total revenue and approximately \$16 billion of AI-semiconductor revenue — the incremental read into the custom-silicon hyperscaler complex following the NVDA beat-and-raise August 27 and the MRVL sequential-timing compression August 28. Per Federal Reserve calendar, the September 15–16 FOMC meeting sits eleven calendar days out from Friday's payrolls print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a full trading week that hands the sleeve a labor-market cadence Tue-through-Friday and layers the AVGO custom-silicon read midweek — sets the incremental September rate-decision distribution against a jobs-and-AI-semi read that historically tends to move the front-end curve and the AI-compute leg materially in either direction.

2. Iran War Six-Month Anniversary Marked Friday With a Two-Sided Diplomatic Signal From Tehran — Araghchi Signaled Openness to Diplomacy Conditioned on Washington Ending Its Pressure Campaign, and the Qatari-Mediated Hormuz Corridor Framework Continues to Advance. Per The Manila Times and CBS News coverage of the anniversary sequence, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi indicated Tehran remains open to diplomacy but conditioned any return to the negotiating table on Washington abandoning its pressure campaign; per Al Jazeera and The Hill coverage, the Iran-Oman phased Hormuz corridor framework continues to advance through the Qatari-mediated Tehran track following the August 27 Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani meeting with Araghchi. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop, Egypt's Banque Misr is reviewing the US Treasury secondary-sanctions notice served at the six-month war mark and the UAE central bank launched an urgent exposure examination — the enforcement perimeter widening through the Gulf financial-services layer. Per data drop, USO closed Friday ↓0.24% at \$129.70 and BNO ↓0.44% at \$51.48 — a crude complex compressed by the post-Warsh dollar bid rather than expanded on the diplomatic-signal read. For FCI positioning, the composition — a two-sided Iran diplomatic signal against a

widening secondary-sanctions perimeter and a Qatari-mediated corridor framework — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) at the intersection of the physical-friction floor and the diplomatic negotiating window into the September 24 Trump-Xi summit and the November 10 Kuala Lumpur truce expiry.

3. Bitcoin Traded to Approximately \$78,100 Over the Weekend — Below the Friday IBIT-Implied Level — as the Post-Warsh Rate-Repricing Read Continued Into the 24-

Hour Digital-Asset Tape. Per CoinDesk and Coinbase live coverage as of Sunday morning, Bitcoin traded near \$78,100 — roughly ↓2% from the Friday afternoon level implied by the FCI digital-asset ETF closes at IBIT \$43.90 (↓3.07%) and ETHA \$18.37 (↓2.65%) per data drop — extending the post-Warsh dollar-and-real-yield compression into the weekend 24-hour tape. Per Benzinga coverage cited in the data drop headlines linking the Friday gold-and-bitcoin sell-off to the September rate-hike-odds jump toward roughly 60% following Chair Warsh’s hawkish Jackson Hole speech, the parallel debasement-bid compression across the gold-and-bitcoin complex sat consistent with the September rate-hike-odds jump; per data drop, HOOD closed ↓5.01% at \$104.26, MARA ↓10.11% at \$10.67, and HUT ↓8.85% at \$79.42 as the FCI fintech-and-miner sleeve gave back a portion of the week’s bid on the Friday reversal. For FCI positioning, the composition — a weekend digital-asset tape extending Friday’s hawkish-Warsh compression — keeps the IBIT and ETHA expressions reading through the September rate-decision distribution rather than the incremental payments-and-policy Jackson Hole framing captured earlier in the week.

4. Carson’s SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Friday’s \$768.31 Intraday Low Left the Level Untouched; No New Levels Set.

Per levels.json, Carson’s active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Friday’s \$768.31–\$775.30 SPY intraday range per data drop and now sits approximately 16.1% below the last cash-market print at \$769.35. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With Monday’s cash open sequencing the ISM-and-JOLTS release Tuesday, the Wednesday ADP-and-Beige-Book cadence, Thursday ISM Services, Friday’s August payrolls print, and the AVGO fiscal Q3 release Wednesday, September 2 after the close ahead of the September 15–16 FOMC meeting, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the sequence. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 69 “Greed” reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto index; per finhacker.cz historical coverage cited in prior briefs and per Liberated Stock Trader August 2026 tracking, the CNN stock-market F&G reading sat near 58 “Greed” earlier in the week and likely moderated further on Friday’s Warsh reversal — treat as approximate for this brief.

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